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| <b>Media Representations</b> | <p>How the media portray events, issues, individuals and social groups.</p> | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• the way events, issues, individuals (including self-representation) and social groups (including social identity) are represented through processes of selection and combination</li> <li>• the way the media through re-presentation constructs versions of reality</li> <li>• the processes which lead media producers to make choices about how to represent events, issues, individuals and social groups</li> <li>• the effect of social and cultural context on representations</li> </ul> |
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| Subject Content |                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
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| Topic           | Key Idea                         | Learners must have studied                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|                 |                                  | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• how and why stereotypes can be used positively and negatively</li> <li>• how and why particular social groups, in a national and global context, may be under-represented or misrepresented</li> <li>• how media representations convey values, attitudes and beliefs about the world and how these may be systematically reinforced across a wide range of media representations</li> <li>• how audiences respond to and interpret media representations</li> <li>• the way in which representations make claims about realism</li> <li>• the impact of industry contexts on the choices media producers make about how to represent events, issues, individuals and social groups</li> <li>• the effect of historical context on representations</li> <li>• how representations may invoke discourses and ideologies and position<sup>4</sup> audiences</li> <li>• how audience responses to and interpretations of media representations reflect social, cultural and historical circumstances.</li> </ul> |
|                 | Theories of media representation | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• theories of representation, including Hall</li> <li>• theories of identity, including Gauntlett</li> <li>• feminist theories, including Bell Hooks and Van Zoonen</li> <li>• theories of gender performativity, including Butler</li> <li>• theories around ethnicity and postcolonial theory, including Gilroy.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

| Subject Content  |                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
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| Media Industries | How the media industries' processes of production, distribution and circulation affect media forms and platforms. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• processes of production, distribution and circulation by organisations, groups and individuals in a global context</li> <li>• the specialised and institutionalised nature of media production, distribution and circulation</li> <li>• the relationship of recent technological change and media production, distribution and circulation</li> <li>• the significance of patterns of ownership and control, including conglomerate ownership, vertical integration and diversification</li> <li>• the significance of economic factors, including commercial and not-for-profit public funding, to media industries and their products</li> <li>• how media organisations maintain, including through marketing, varieties of audiences nationally and globally</li> <li>• the regulatory framework of contemporary media in the UK</li> <li>• the impact of 'new' digital technologies on media regulation, including the role of individual producers</li> <li>• how processes of production, distribution and circulation shape media products</li> <li>• the impact of digitally convergent media platforms on media production, distribution and circulation, including individual producers</li> <li>• the role of regulation in global production, distribution and circulation</li> <li>• the effect of individual producers on media industries.</li> </ul> |
|                  | Theories of media industries.                                                                                     | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• power and media industries, including Curran and Seaton</li> <li>• theories of regulation, including those of Livingstone and Lunt</li> <li>• theories of cultural industries, including those of Hesmondhalgh.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |

| Subject Content |                                                                                                                                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
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| Media Audiences | How media forms target, reach and address audiences, how audiences interpret and respond to them and how members of audiences become producers themselves. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• how audiences are grouped and categorised by media industries, including by age, gender and social class, as well as by lifestyle and taste</li> <li>• how media producers target, attract, reach, address and potentially construct audiences</li> <li>• how media industries target audiences through the content and appeal of media products and through the ways in which they are marketed, distributed and circulated</li> <li>• the interrelationship between media technologies and patterns of consumption and response</li> <li>• how audiences interpret the media, including how they may interpret the same media in different ways</li> <li>• how audiences interact with the media and can be actively involved in media production</li> <li>• how specialised audiences can be reached, both on a national and global scale, through different media technologies and platforms</li> <li>• how media organisations reflect the different needs of mass and specialised audiences, including through targeting</li> <li>• how audiences use media in different ways, reflecting demographic factors as well as aspects of identity and cultural capital</li> <li>• the role and significance of specialised audiences, including niche and fan, to the media</li> <li>• the way in which different audience interpretations reflect social, cultural and historical circumstances.</li> </ul> |
|                 | Theories of media audiences.                                                                                                                               | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• media effects, including Bandura</li> <li>• cultivation theory, including Gerbner</li> <li>• reception theory, including Hall</li> <li>• theories of fandom, including Jenkins</li> <li>• theories of 'end of audience', including Shirky.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |